CHRISTOPHER MODICAI RATENG

Information Security | Threat Detection & Vulnerability Management | FinTech Payments

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

Information security and technical operations professional with 5+ years of experience supporting managed-service clients and multi-site retail and financial-services environments. Implemented endpoint hardening, EDR/antivirus controls and patching across 100+ endpoint environments, contributing to a 30% reduction in security incidents. Experienced in network segmentation, access control, incident triage, root cause analysis, secure API design and Python/Bash automation; practical SIEM/IDS exposure through an independent security laboratory. Founder of a production RegTech platform for fintech organisations across 4 African jurisdictions; completing an MSc in Information Systems (Information Security).

CORE COMPETENCIES & TECHNOLOGIES

Security Operations & Tools: Endpoint Detection & Response (EDR); Antivirus; Endpoint Hardening; Patch Management; Vulnerability Management; Incident Triage & Remediation; Root Cause Analysis; Security Monitoring; Active Directory; Azure AD; Microsoft 365; MFA; RBAC; Least-Privilege Access Controls; Windows; Linux; VLANs; ACLs; VPNs; MPLS; Wazuh SIEM, Suricata IDS & pfSense (laboratory).

Governance & Compliance: Risk & Compliance Awareness; IBM GRC Training; Security Policy Adherence; Auditability; Backup & Disaster Recovery; Financial-Services/POS Systems; Transaction Reconciliation; Data Privacy; MITRE ATT&CK (laboratory); Regulatory Intelligence; Coordinated Vulnerability Disclosure Research.

DevSecOps & Automation: Application & API Security; REST APIs; Node.js; Fastify; JWT Authentication; Input Validation; Rate Limiting; HTTPS/TLS; RBAC; Secrets Management; Git/GitHub; Python; Bash; SQL/PostgreSQL; Microsoft Azure; Docker; Production Security Controls; Automation Workflows.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT Support Manager

Aug 2023 – Present

Net Scaling Solutions, LLC (Managed Services Provider) | Remote – Maryland, USA / Nairobi, Kenya

- Implemented endpoint hardening, EDR/antivirus controls, remediation and scheduled patch deployment across supported client environments, contributing to a 30% reduction in security incidents.
- Monitored client systems and handled end-to-end incident triage, root cause investigation, escalations and resolution across 100+ distributed endpoints and 15+ daily support requests under SLAs.
- Automated diagnostics, system-health checks and alerting with Python and Bash, reducing mean time to resolution by approximately 25%.
- Administered Microsoft 365, Active Directory and Azure AD for environments supporting 100+ endpoints, including MFA, provisioning, access controls and account lifecycle management.
- Standardised runbooks and escalation hand-offs while mentoring 3 junior engineers, reducing recurring support requests by approximately 20%.

IT Support Specialist

Oct 2020 – Aug 2023

Sledge Group Enterprises Ltd (Retail & Financial Services) | Nairobi, Kenya / Regional Operations

- Led multi-site branch network deployments supporting 100+ users, implementing VLAN segmentation for POS, back-office and CCTV systems, alongside VPNs, ACLs, Huawei switching and MPLS WAN connectivity.
- Delivered Level 1/Level 2 incident investigation and service restoration for 100+ users in retail and financial-services operations, resolving approximately 95% of support requests within 30 minutes.
- Managed the lifecycle of 200+ IT devices through procurement, deployment, preventive maintenance, inventory control, vendor coordination and secure disposal.
- Established backup and disaster-recovery procedures for 2 TB+ of business-critical data, achieving 100% successful recovery during scheduled test restores.
- Authored support SOPs, troubleshooting guides and user training materials that reduced recurring service requests by approximately 20%.

Founder & Lead Product Builder

2025 – Present

SheriaBot | Kenya / African Markets

- Built a production B2B regulatory intelligence platform spanning 4 African jurisdictions, implementing application authentication, RBAC, organisation isolation, auditability and secure operational controls.
- Architected 10+ interconnected compliance capabilities across frontend, backend, data and cloud infrastructure, including secure API workflows and access-controlled business operations.
- Designed and reviewed 7+ specialised automation workflows with approval gates, semantic checks, traceability and operational safeguards for regulated-content processes.
- Implemented a 5-tier SaaS entitlement model with organisation roles, seat enforcement, usage accounting and controlled pilot-to-paid conversion, preserving access governance across customer organisations.

IT Support Intern

Sep 2019 – Dec 2019

Royal Media Services | Nairobi, Kenya

- Administered Active Directory for 200+ users, supporting account provisioning, permissions, password resets, group-policy changes and onboarding/offboarding.
- Developed troubleshooting documentation for desktop and network issues, contributing to a 30% reduction in recurring support requests.

SELECTED SECURITY & ENGINEERING PROJECTS

SheriaBot – Secure Fintech / RegTech Application Delivery *Production platform*

Built and operate a production application using Node.js, Fastify, PostgreSQL, REST APIs, JWT authentication, input validation, rate limiting, HTTPS/TLS and controlled cloud deployment. Implemented organisation-level access boundaries, RBAC, auditability, session validation and secrets-management safeguards. sheriabot.com

Cyber Threat Hunting Laboratory *Independent security project*

Deployed a SOC-style laboratory using pfSense, Suricata IDS and Wazuh SIEM, mapping detection activity to MITRE ATT&CK and reporting an estimated 40% improvement in practical threat-analysis visibility; laboratory exercise, not a production SOC deployment.

POS / EFRIS Integration Defect Investigation *Financial-services systems*

Reproduced an Uganda POS–EFRIS stock-synchronisation discrepancy, documented technical evidence and supplied a video demonstration to South Africa-based developers to support cross-team root cause investigation.

EDUCATION

Master of Science in Information Systems – Information Security Expected Nov 2026

United States International University–Africa, Nairobi, Kenya

Focus: Network Security, Vulnerability Management, Digital Forensics, Risk Management, Governance & Compliance. **Bachelor of Science in Information Systems & Technology – Networking** 2019

United States International University–Africa, Nairobi, Kenya

CERTIFICATIONS

- Cisco CyberOps Associate – Cisco, 2025
- Ethical Hacker – Cisco Networking Academy, 2025
- IBM SkillsBuild Cybersecurity Certificate – IBM, 2025
- Governance, Risk, Compliance, and Data Privacy – IBM, 2025
- Incident Response and Systems Forensics – IBM, 2025
- Information Technology Fundamentals – IBM SkillsBuild, 2022

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

Languages: English (Professional); Swahili (Native); German (Elementary).
Availability: Two weeks after offer acceptance (notice period).
Research: MSc thesis examines coordinated vulnerability disclosure workflow maturity in Kenyan mobile-money systems, referencing ISO/IEC 29147 and ISO/IEC 30111.